Bill Dean

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Work Experience

Independent Web & Mobile Developer, 742 Studios - Toronto, ON
Feb 2025 – Present

- Designing and developing full-stack web and mobile applications independently and for select clients, managing projects end-to-end from architecture to deployment.
- Cross-platform mobile development with React Native, applying existing React expertise to build native mobile experiences.
- Implementing CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions to automate testing and deployment workflows across personal and client projects.
- Integrating AI-assisted development tools, including Claude Code, into the development workflow to accelerate prototyping, improve code quality, and increase delivery speed**.**
- Tech Stack: React, React Native, Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind, Playwright, GitHub Actions, Claude Code.

Web Developer, ASL19 - Toronto, ON
Nov 2017 – Jan 2025

- Developed dynamic front-end interfaces for 15+ projects, emphasizing performance and scalability with reusable components.
- Improved application reliability, accessibility and day-to-day workflow with comprehensive testing (Jest, Playwright) integrated into CI/CD pipelines.
- Conducted thorough code reviews for a team of 3 developers, providing feedback aligned with coding standards, quality, and best practices.
- Collaborated closely with design, back-end, and DevOps teams to define component APIs and visual direction.
- Tech Stack: React, NextJS, TypeScript, GraphQL, Emotion CSS, Python, Django, Wagtail CMS, Jest, Playwright.

Systems Support Analyst / Web Developer, Pearson Embanet - Toronto, ON
May 2009 – Nov 2017

- Developed and managed 200+ websites and landing pages for various educational institutions with a focus on usability and cross-browser performance.
- Collaborated with design and engineering teams to align site architecture with user needs and business goals.
- Automated website maintenance workflows with Bash scripting, improving deployment speed and reliability.
- Provided support for AWS cloud infrastructure by setting up new environments, maintaining version control systems, and overseeing website deployments.
- Tech Stack: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, jQuery, WordPress, PHP, AWS, Bash.

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Skills

Front-End: React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Tailwind CSS, component libraries
State & Data: GraphQL, REST API integration, performance optimization
Back-End: Python, Django
CMS: Wagtail, WordPress, Strapi
Testing & QA: Jest, Playwright, unit testing, end-to-end testing, CI/CD pipelines
Accessibility: WCAG Standards, ARIA, Accessibility Audits
Tools & Workflow: Git, Figma, responsive design, cross-browser compatibility, SEO, ESLint, Prettier
AI: Claude Code, GitHub CoPilot, OpenCode

Projects

NextStarter nextstarter.app

- Built and launched NextStarter, an accessible Next.js boilerplate available as a free open-source edition and a commercial Pro edition.
- Designed the free edition to meet WCAG 2.1 AA, with Axe-core accessibility checks on every CI run and Lighthouse scores of 100 across all four categories on desktop.
- Extended Pro into a full SaaS foundation with Clerk authentication, Prisma and PostgreSQL, Stripe subscriptions with webhook sync, Resend email, an admin dashboard and Sentry error tracking.
- Published create-nextstarter, a CLI that scaffolds a new project with a single command.
- Tech stack: Next.js 16, React 19, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS v4, shadcn/ui, Prisma, PostgreSQL, Stripe, Playwright, GitHub Actions, Claude Code.

Education

International Academy of Design and Technology - Digital Media Design, Toronto, ON
Keyin Technical College - Diploma in Computer Science, Halifax, NS
St. Francis Xavier University - Bachelor of Arts in Music, Antigonish, NS